English SP

True / False / Not Given

One question type — eight real exam questions from the 2012 and 2013 DSE English Paper 1

Reading comprehension — the three-way choice

TODAY'S lesson

8 exam questions
28 statements (28 marks)

2012: Part A, B1, B2
2013: Part A, B1, B2

Read the paragraph — then decide: True / False / Not Given

[8] The drinks at Polar Cafe cost around Bt80 (approx HK$20), and for that price you get to try out any game for an hour. Buy another drink and play for another hour. There are about 40 games to choose from at this point, most of them imported from Germany and the US. There's little foreign text to slow you down, and anyway you get Thai instructions and the staff can help with the rules.

[9] 'I played nothing but *Monopoly*, *Uno* and *Snakes & Ladders* when I was a child,' says Pat, a Thai University business-management graduate. 'There weren't that many games available in Thailand, but when I studied in the US, I found a lot of interesting board games that were more challenging than anything on the computer.'

Decide whether the following statements are True, False, or the information is Not Given in paragraphs 8-9. Put a tick (✓) in the appropriate column. (4 marks)

(i) Customers can play board games for two hours if they buy two drinks.	✓ T	F	NG	78%
(j) You need good English to play games imported from Germany or the US.	T	✓ F	NG	39%
(k) Pat never played Monopoly, Uno or Snakes & Ladders as a child.	T	✓ F	NG	82%
(l) Pat thinks computer games are not as challenging as some board games.	✓ T	F	NG	72%

Read the paragraph — then decide: True / False / Not Given

[13] One teacher who received an email, invited the students in her school to take part. Five-year-old Dylan worked with his classmates on a small quilt. 'We all made different pledges and we wrote our ages and our names,' he says.

[14] Dylan pledged to use less water when washing his hands while fourteen-year-old Rachel and her brother Jacob, who is two years younger, had other ideas.

[15] 'A lot of people don't finish what's on their plate and end up throwing away a lot of food. But if they just saved their leftovers, it would help a lot,' says Rachel.

Text 2, ¶13–15

[16] 'My pledge was to put paper, plastic, glass and metal waste into different recycling containers instead of in the rubbish bin,' Jacob says.

[17] Eleven-year-old Patrick says the climate quilt project was a chance for him to lend a hand and express his creativity.

[18] 'I learned that recycling is important,' Patrick says. 'And you should do it every day when you get an opportunity. I drew some smiley faces to reflect my personality.'

[19] Shauna Munshower's four children made pledge patches for the Climate Quilt. She says the project was a fun learning experience for them.

[20] The campaign has made them think about the way they behave and she believes that small actions could spread through the example of children. She adds, 'It will also be good if they got interested in quilting and sewing. That would be nice, I would like that.'

[21] Phyllis Smith liked the idea and decided to volunteer. 'I'm sewing together the beautiful strips that the kids have made,' she says. 'They are fantastic. You read them and go, ''Wow.'' We're supposed to be sewing and we can't sew while we're reading them — how great they are!'

Text 2, ¶16–21

Decide whether the following statements are True, False, or the information is Not Given in paragraphs 13-21. Put a tick (✓) in the appropriate column. (4 marks)

(i) Only children stitched the quilt.	T	✓ F	NG	62%
(j) Rachel and Jacob are related.	✓ T	F	NG	68%
(k) Jacob and Patrick are classmates.	T	F	✓ NG	64%
(l) Each participant could express their personality through the pledge patches.	✓ T	F	NG	59%

Read the paragraph — then decide: True / False / Not Given

5 [2] One real Chinese mom is 39-year-old Guo Jing, a government office-worker in Beijing with 8-year-old twins. (Yale law professor Amy Chua is of Filipino-Chinese descent and lives in the U.S., not in China.) 'I won't be like Amy Chua,' says Guo about her kids' upbringing. 'I don't want to pressure them ... in the future I'd like them to have their own hobbies, to develop their own abilities. I won't make decisions for them.'

10 [3] Guo says she believes her sons love their extracurricular hobbies, such as painting and learning how to play *weiqi* (the Chinese equivalent of chess), not because she forces them into it, but precisely because she does not: 'I didn't give them any pressure.' If that isn't a startling admission, here's the clincher: Guo is so convinced that her kids need more than a traditional Chinese education that she's sending them to a private, bilingual international school where kids learn both 15 English and Chinese in a comparatively looser classroom environment. 'I try my best to adopt both Chinese and Western educational ways.'

Decide whether the following statements are True, False, or the information is Not Given in paragraphs 2-3. Put a tick (✓) in the appropriate column. (3 marks)

(i) Chua was born in the Philippines.	T	F	NG ✓	82%
(j) Chua forces her children to do certain activities.	✓	F	NG	79%
(k) Guo is unhappy her sons are learning painting and weiqi.	T	✓	NG	84%

Read the paragraph — then decide: True / False / Not Given

[2] In an earthen pit in central China, under what used to be their village's persimmon orchard, three middle-aged women are hunched over an ancient jigsaw puzzle. Yang Rongrong, a cheerful 57-year-old turns over a jagged piece in her callused hands and fits it into the perfect spot. The other women laugh as if enjoying an afternoon amusement in their village near the city of Xian. What Yang and her friends are doing, in fact, is piecing together the 2,200-year-old mystery of the terra-cotta army, part of the celebrated (and still dimly understood) burial complex of China's first emperor, Qin Shi Huang Di.

[3] It usually takes Yang and her co-workers many days to transform a heap of clay fragments into a full-size warrior, but today they are lucky, accomplishing the task in a matter of hours. Yang has been solving such puzzles since 1974, when farmers from her village of Xiyang first unearthed pottery and a sculpted head while digging a well for their orchard. Having helped reassemble an army of a thousand warriors, Yang examines a clay head sheathed in protective plastic. Visible through the wrap are flashes of pink and red, brilliant hues that hint at the original glory of the terra-cotta warriors.

Read paragraphs 2-3 and decide whether the following statements are True, False, or the information is Not Given. Blacken ONE circle only for each statement.

(i) The three women in the persimmon orchard are the same age. — T / F / NG ✓ — 72%

(j) The burial complex remains a mystery. — T ✓ / F / NG — 61%

(k) It usually takes a few hours to piece together a complete terra-cotta warrior. — T / F ✓ / NG — 67%

(iv) Yang Rongrong has been piecing together terra-cotta warriors for 39 years. **This statement was deleted by HKEAA — the question is marked out of 3 here.**

Read the paragraph — then decide: True / False / Not Given

[11] With less than one percent of the vast tomb complex excavated so far, it may take centuries to uncover all that remains hidden. But the pace of discovery is quickening. In 2011 the museum launched two long-term excavation projects on the flanks of the 250-foot-high central burial mound. Exploratory digs in this area a decade ago uncovered a group of terra-cotta acrobats and strong men. More extensive excavations will yield 'mind-boggling discoveries' which will amaze everyone, predicts Wu Yongqi, the museum's director.

Read paragraph 11 and decide whether the following statements are True, False, or the information is Not Given. Blacken ONE circle only for each statement. (3 marks)

(i) Only a small portion of the tomb has been excavated. — T ✓ / F / NG — 64%

(j) The speed of discovering new artifacts is slowing down. — T / F ✓ / NG — 68%

(k) In 2011, the museum completed the excavation of the central burial mound. — T / F ✓ / NG — 40%

Read the paragraph — then decide: True / False / Not Given

[1] The guzheng has been a popular Chinese instrument since ancient times. It originated during the Warring States period and first became popular during the Qin Dynasty.

[2] After surviving the turbulent times of the Cultural Revolution, its popularity was restored and today it is one of the most loved Chinese instruments, recognised as a representative of traditional Chinese culture around the world.

[3] 'Chinese people are attracted to [learning] the guzheng because they have been exposed to its sound since childhood,' says Zou Lunlun, guzheng artist and founder of the *International Academy for Musical Arts*.

[4] 'Westerners are attracted to it because of its exotic and relaxing sound. The skills of playing the guzheng bring many benefits, such as artistic expression, sense of accomplishment, stress relief, social activity and physical activity.'

[5] Zou, born into a family of guzheng musicians who go back four generations, has travelled the world as a master performer. She has played for celebrities and politicians who include the former prime ministers of Australia and New Zealand, and former president Jiang Zemin.

[6] Now based in Hong Kong, Zou founded the *International Academy for Musical Arts* in North Point in 2006. The school offers guzheng classes to children and adults taught by Zou. Students can choose from a group class, one-to-one tuition or lessons available via Skype.

Decide whether the following statements are True, False, or the information is Not Given. Blacken ONE circle only for each statement. (4 marks)

(i) Zou teaches the guzheng. — ~~T~~ ✓ / F / NG — 83%

(j) The guzheng is Zou's favourite instrument. — T / F / ~~NG~~ ✓ — 67%

(k) No one else in Zou's family can play the guzheng. — T / ~~F~~ ✓ / NG — 76%

(l) Famous people have attended Zou's performances. — ~~T~~ ✓ / F / NG — 51%

Read the paragraph — then decide: True / False / Not Given

Read paragraphs 7-9 and decide whether the following statements are True, False, or the information is Not Given. Blacken ONE circle only for each statement. (3 marks)

(i) People with low self-esteem feel that Facebook is a safe place to share information about themselves.

T ✓ F NG — 57%

(j) It is more difficult to read someone's reaction when you talk to them face to face than through Facebook.

T F ✓ NG — 36%

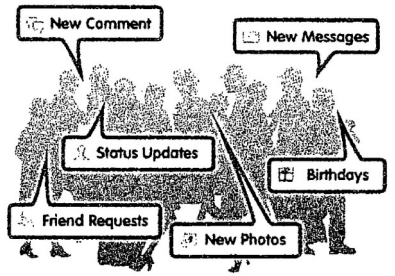
(k) Participants of the study checked their e-mails even though they said they would rather sleep.

T ✓ F NG — 47%

[7] So people with low self-esteem may feel that Facebook is a risk-free forum for making personal disclosures, but they may not be helping themselves.

Text 3, ¶7

[8] 'If you're talking to somebody in person and you say something negative, you might get an indication that they don't like it,' says Forest. But when people have a negative reaction to a post on Facebook, they seem to keep it to themselves. 'On Facebook, you don't see most of the reactions.'



[9] Is Facebook about popularity or desperation? It may often edge towards the latter, with evidence that Facebook is as addictive as cigarettes and alcohol. A study of the activities and desires of 200 adults by the University of Chicago showed that although the strongest desires were for sleep, checking work e-mails and updating a Facebook status are this generation's actual nocturnal activities.

[10] In theory, social networking websites like Facebook could be great for people with low self-esteem. Sharing is important for improving friendships. But in practice, people with low self-esteem seem to behave counterproductively, bombarding their friends with negative tidbits about their lives and making themselves less likeable.

Text 3, ¶8–9

Read the paragraph — then decide: True / False / Not Given

[4] Collins's trilogy is only the most visible example of a recent boom in dystopian fiction for young people. Many of these books come in series, spinning out extended narratives in intricately imagined worlds. In the popular *Uglies* series, for example, all sixteen-year-olds undergo surgery to conform to a universal standard of prettiness determined by evolutionary biology; in *The Maze Runner*, teenage boys awaken, all memories of their

Text 4, ¶4

[5] Dystopian novels for young-adult readers have been around for decades. Readers of a certain age may remember having their young minds blown by *House of Stairs*, the story of five teenagers imprisoned in a seemingly infinite M. C. Escher-style network of staircases that ultimately turns out to be a gigantic Skinner box designed to condition their behavior. *The White Mountains*, in which alien overlords install mind-control caps on the heads of all those over the age of thirteen, tore through my own sixth-grade classroom like a wicked strain of the flu. Depending on the anxieties and preoccupations of its time, a dystopian young-adult novel might speculate about the aftermath of nuclear war (*Z for Zachariah*) or the drawbacks of engineering a too harmonious social order (*The Giver*) or the consequences of resource exhaustion (*The Carbon Diaries 2015*). And, of course, most American schoolchildren are at some point also assigned to read one of the twentieth century's dystopian classics for adults, such as *Brave New World* or *1984*.

Text 4, ¶5

Read paragraphs 4-5 and decide whether the following statements are True, False, or the information is Not Given. Blacken ONE circle only for each statement. (4 marks)

(i) The Hunger Games is the only example of the current popularity in dystopian fiction. — T / ✓F / NG — 84%

(j) In the Uglies, teenagers conform to a standard prettiness by undergoing surgery. — ✓T / F / NG — 88%

(k) Most participants of the Internet discussion board are teenagers. — T / F / ✓NG — 87%

(l) Brave New World and 1984 were written for American schoolchildren. — T / ✓F / NG — 68%